

LA.4 Where to File Directory

Parish or town, staff or contractor — how to find the office that will actually handle your parcel, and a page to write down what you confirmed.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Louisiana writes one mandatory construction code for the whole state and then hands enforcement to each parish and municipality, which is why the code your house must meet is the same in Cameron Parish as in Caddo while the office that inspects it, the forms it hands you and the fee it charges are not. Confirm every local item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it.

THERE IS NO SUCH THING AS A NO-PERMIT PARISH

If you have built in Texas, Mississippi or Alabama, you will be looking for the rural parish where nobody enforces anything. It does not exist in Louisiana, and the belief that it does is the most expensive misconception an owner-builder can carry into this state.

The enforcement statute says every municipality and parish **shall** enforce the Uniform Construction Code, and then closes the door expressly: **“Nothing in this Chapter allows any local government to avoid enforcement.”** An older version of Louisiana law did let a parish file an affidavit claiming an exemption. That mechanism is gone from the operative text — the section heading still carries the words, but the affidavit itself is no longer there. If you find a page telling you your parish opted out, it is describing repealed law.

Checked against the Commission's own register, September 2026

Every one of Louisiana's **64 parish governments** was run through the Uniform Construction Code Commission's public jurisdiction registry. **All 64 returned a credential number.** Not most. All of them. Whatever else is true about how thinly your parish is staffed, it is a registered code enforcement jurisdiction, and LA.3 gives you the statutory route to get inspected when the counter is quiet.

PARISH OR TOWN? SETTLE THIS FIRST

The parish building official is appointed to oversee **the unincorporated area** of the parish. Inside a town's corporate limits, the town is the authority. Roughly 150 Louisiana municipalities are registered with the Commission separately from the 64 parish governments, which is direct evidence that those towns run their own code enforcement.

A mailing address is not a jurisdiction

A parcel with a Ruston, Covington or Opelousas mailing address may sit well outside those city limits — and the reverse happens too. Before you drive anywhere, confirm in writing whether the parcel is inside or outside the corporate limits. Filing in the wrong place costs weeks, and in a couple of parishes the reach is genuinely surprising: St. Landry Parish's permit office states that it also covers anyone inside the city limits of Arnaudville, Palmetto and Melville.

HOW TO FIND YOUR OFFICE, IN THREE STEPS

Finding the office that handles your parcel

1	Confirm the jurisdiction	Settle whether the parcel is inside a municipality or in the unincorporated parish. The assessor's parcel record and the parish GIS map will tell you; get it in writing.
2	Find the office	Start from the State of Louisiana's own parish index at la.gov (Local Louisiana), which links every parish government site. Then look for Permits, Permits & Inspections, Planning & Development, Planning & Zoning, Community Development, or Public Works — Louisiana files permitting under all six names.
3	Find the inspector	Use the Commission's public search, reachable from lsuccc.la , to look up your jurisdiction and the licensed inspectors who cover it. This is also how you check that a private inspector you are considering is genuinely licensed, and how you find one who already works your parish.

This kit prints office names rather than deep links. Permit-page URLs are the fastest-rotting thing in any directory — several Louisiana parish pages found during verification still point at a state web address that was retired — while an office name and a route to it stay good. Both starting points above are stable state-level entry points.

Your parish may have hired its building official

Louisiana expressly allows a parish to contract enforcement out — to another government, to a regional planning commission, or to a licensed private inspector. Several parishes publish exactly who that is. Bossier Parish states that **Code Inspections Plus** “serves as the building official for Bossier Parish.” St. Martin Parish states that all construction inspections are conducted by **Building Code Inspection Services, LLC**, a contracted third-party provider. Union Parish names **Lagniappe Inspection Services** as its building official. Concordia Parish states that **IBTS** handles all inspections for the parish. Caddo Parish has an agreement under which the **City of Shreveport** performs all residential inspections for the parish.

Two regional planning commissions do this work at scale: the **Rapides Area Planning Commission**, which covers unincorporated Rapides and took on Vernon Parish in March 2025, and the **South Central Planning & Development Commission** in Houma, which describes itself as providing code enforcement across a five-parish region. If your parish website is thin on permitting detail, this is usually why — the work is happening somewhere else.

A large share of Louisiana jurisdictions take applications through a shared online permitting portal rather than at a counter. Ask which portal yours uses before you make the drive.

PARISH DIRECTORY

Office names below were read off each parish government's own website in September 2026. Names change; use this to know what you are looking for and who to ask for, then confirm at the counter.

Parish permitting offices, read from official parish sites (September 2026)

Parish	Governing body	Office	Notes
Acadia	Police Jury	Building Permits office	Publishes a Self Contracting Form for owner-builders and a no-sewer affidavit. Under 200 sq ft, no permit.
Ascension	Parish Government	Building Department / Permitting, under Planning & Development	Has a Residential New Construction application, an address application and a flood zone determination form.
Allen	Police Jury	Permits, Buildings & Solid Waste	Permit required before construction, wiring, piping, re-roofing or moving a manufactured home.
Beauregard	Police Jury	Permit Office	Permit required outside city or town limits. Wants the assessor parcel listing, culvert permit, 911 permit, sewer permit and your electric account number.
Bossier	Police Jury	Building official is a contracted private firm	Bossier City and Benton permit separately.
Caddo	Parish Commission	Public Works — Permits Division	Residential inspections performed by the City of Shreveport under agreement. The parish page lists stale code years; the state codes govern.
Concordia	Police Jury	Police Jury permit intake	Inspections performed by a contracted provider.

Parish permitting offices, read from official parish sites (September 2026)

Parish	Governing body	Office	Notes
East Baton Rouge	Consolidated city-parish	Permits & Inspections Division, Department of Development	Baker, Central, Zachary and St. George permit their own.
Grant	Police Jury	Building Permit Office	States that only the homeowner or a licensed builder may apply. E-911 address requested from the sheriff's office first.
Iberia	Parish Government	Permits Department	New Iberia permits separately.
Iberville	Parish Government	Permits & Inspections Department	Online-only filing. Plaquemine, St. Gabriel, White Castle and Maringouin permit separately.
Jackson	Police Jury	Uniform Building Code office	Permits by email or mail, with a published checklist; three to five business day review.
Jefferson	Parish Government	Building Permits Department	Engineering automatically reviews every new dwelling permit. Gretna, Harahan, Kenner, Westwego, Grand Isle and Jean Lafitte permit separately.
Lafayette	Consolidated city-parish	Development and Planning Department	Broussard, Carencro, Duson, Scott and Youngsville permit separately.
Lafourche	Parish Government	Permits & Planning Department	A current electric utility bill is required with any permit application.
Lincoln	Police Jury	Police Jury permit intake — issues a Project Permit	Separate residential driveway-culvert application. Ruston, Grambling, Dubach, Choudrant and Simsboro permit separately.
Livingston	Parish Government	Building & Permit Department	Publishes a request for flood zone determination. Denham Springs, Walker and Livingston permit separately.
Natchitoches	Parish Government	Planning & Zoning Department	City of Natchitoches permits separately.
Orleans	City and parish are coterminous	Department of Safety and Permits	The only permit authority in the parish. Separate divisions for electrical, mechanical, floodplain and stormwater.
Ouachita	Police Jury	Parish Permit Office	Publishes a roster of registered third-party private inspectors — the clearest illustration in the state of the private-inspector route.

Parish permitting offices, read from official parish sites (September 2026)

Parish	Governing body	Office	Notes
Plaquemines	Parish Government	Permits, Planning & Zoning	Filing runs through an online portal; confirm the office name at the counter.
Rapides	Police Jury	Rapides Area Planning Commission, under contract	The Police Jury site lists no permit office. Alexandria, Pineville, Ball and Boyce permit separately.
Red River	Police Jury	Permit Officer division	
Sabine	Police Jury	Building Code Office	Separate parish planning commission.
St. Bernard	Parish Government	Department of Community Development	Publishes new residential construction and elevation requirement documents.
St. Helena	Police Jury	Building Department	Publishes a six-step permit process starting at the 911 office. The page cites a stale code year; the state codes govern.
St. James	Parish Government	Office of Planning and Permitting	
St. Landry	Parish Government	Parish Permits Office	Also covers anyone inside the city limits of Arnaudville, Palmetto and Melville. By appointment. Issues temporary electrical service on new construction.
St. Martin	Parish Government	Building Permits Department	All construction inspections conducted by a contracted third-party provider.
St. Tammany	Parish Government	Department of Permits and Inspections	Also runs parish contractor registration.
Tangipahoa	Parish Government	Parish Permit Office	Amite, Hammond, Ponchatoula, Independence, Tickfaw, Roseland, Kentwood and Tangipahoa village permit separately.
Terrebonne	Consolidated city-parish	Permits Division, under Planning and Zoning	Also issues culvert and coastal use permits and holds elevation certificates.
Union	Police Jury	Police Jury office; building official is a contracted firm	Publishes the clearest counter walkthrough in the state — application form collected from the 911 office.
Vernon	Police Jury	Rapides Area Planning Commission, under contract, with a local office in Leesville	Joined RAPC in March 2025. Bring two sets of plans and a Manual J.

Parish permitting offices, read from official parish sites (September 2026)

Parish	Governing body	Office	Notes
Washington	Parish Government	Licensing & Permits Department	Publishes a single-family residence permitting procedure and a floodplain determination service.
West Baton Rouge	Parish Council	Community Planning & Development — Permit Office	Addis, Brusly and Port Allen permit separately.
West Feliciana	Parish Government	Permits & Inspections	Building, electrical, plumbing, manufactured housing, roofing and culvert permits.

The parishes not listed above

Twenty-seven parishes are absent from that table. That is a statement about this kit's verification standard, not about those parishes: each is a registered code enforcement jurisdiction with the Commission, but an official page naming its permit office could not be read during verification, and this kit does not print an office name it has not seen. They are:

Assumption, Avoyelles, Bienville, Caldwell, Calcasieu, Cameron, Catahoula, Claiborne, DeSoto, East Carroll, East Feliciana, Evangeline, Franklin, Jefferson Davis, LaSalle, Madison, Morehouse, Pointe Coupee, Richland, St. Charles, St. John the Baptist, St. Mary, Tensas, Vermilion, Webster, West Carroll and Winn.

For any of these, work the three steps above. St. Charles Parish is worth one note: it contains **no incorporated municipalities**, so the parish government is the only permit authority anywhere in it — there is no city-versus-parish question to settle.

MY OFFICES — FILL THIS IN AND KEEP IT WITH THE JOB

Confirmed for this project

What	Office / person	Confirmed how and when
Is the parcel inside a municipality? (yes / no)		
Building permit office		
Building official (name and license number)		
Are third-party or private inspectors accepted here?		
Online permit portal used		

Confirmed for this project

What	Office / person	Confirmed how and when
Parish health unit (sewage permit)		
911 / address assignment office		
Floodplain manager		
Culvert / driveway — parish public works or state highway district		
Electrical: may a homeowner pull the permit, and does this jurisdiction register individual electricians?		
Plan review turnaround quoted		

Sources — every Louisiana claim in this document (verified September 2026)

What this document states	Authority
Every municipality and parish shall enforce; no local government may avoid enforcement	R.S. 37:3737(A)(1)
The parish appoints a building official for its unincorporated area	R.S. 37:3741
A parish may contract enforcement to another public entity or a licensed private inspector	R.S. 37:3740
A regional planning commission may hold the building-official role	R.S. 37:3737(G)
All 64 parish governments registered as code enforcement jurisdictions	LUCCC public jurisdiction registry, September 2026
Parish office names, governing bodies and municipal carve-outs	Each parish government's own website, September 2026
Named contracted providers and regional commissions	Bossier, St. Martin, Union, Concordia, Caddo, Rapides and Vernon parish pages
State index of parish governments	la.gov, Local Louisiana

Two lookups answer almost anything this document leaves open. The state parish index at **la.gov** links every parish government. The Commission's public search, from **lsuccc.la**, confirms your jurisdiction is registered and lists the inspectors licensed to cover it — which is also how you check anyone offering to inspect your house. Read September 2026.